

Gamers' God

Nolan Bushnell (born 1943), an electrical engineer and entrepreneur, was named one of Newsweek's "50 Men That Changed America," and is recognised as one of the founding fathers of the video game industry.

Bushnell mulled over several words and finalised "Atari" as the name of the company. Atari was named after a move in the Japanese chess-like game Go, was incorporated in June 1972.

(Talks to release *Pong* through Nutting Associates and other companies were leading nowhere. Industry experts didn't express interest in the game. Bushnell and Tabney therefore decided to launch *Pong* on their own and thus established Atari Inc.)

Eventually, Bushnell and Tabney completed and released *Pong* in November of 1972. It was a coin-operated arcade game system, and consisted of a B&W television, special game hardware, and a coin-operated mechanism. The game itself was based on ping-pong (table tennis), hence the name.

Pong was the world's first popular arcade video game. It was a big hit in the video arcade game market, and is recognised as the first first-generation video game of the 1972–1977 period. In addition, the era is regarded as the time when the age of interactive television and digital electronics arrived.

The computers build after 1972 are referred to as fourth-generation computers; modern-day computers are labelled "fifth generation." The size of computers shrank with the developments taking place on Integrated Circuits—computing systems

Play My Tunes

A Compact Disc Read-Only Memory (CD-ROM) was invented in the US at Philips by Klass Compaan and Pete Kramer in 1972. Later, Sony and Philips officially introduced the CD-ROM format together in 1982.